- **Protein :** Choose lentils and dals, hard-boiled eggs, lean slices of meat and poultry, or fish.
- Avoid breakfast loaded with simple sugars (gets digested early and may feel hungry soon) or dripping in oil (may cause drowsiness throughout the day)

Activity : 1

Choose one special day in the school calendar and decorate the classroom with balloons, tablecloths or student artwork and posters to highlight healthy foods and the importance of breakfast and invite the Principal or Headmistress of the school to eat Breakfast with the children

Activity : 2

Have a breakfast poster competition among students and hang the posters around the school

Nutrition for Adolescents

3.5 Adolescence

Adolescent growth spurt starts at about 10-12 years in girls and two years later in boys. Adolescence is characterized by rapid increase in height and weight, hormonal changes, sexual maturation and wide swings in emotion. Development of critical bone mass is essential during this period as this forms the ground for maintaining mineral integrity of the bone in later life. Adolescent girls are at greater physiological stress than boys because of menstruation. Their nutritional needs are of particular importance as they have to prepare for motherhood.

3.5.1 Growth and Development in Adolescence

According to WHO, individuals between 10 and 19 years are considered adolescents. The period of transition from childhood to adulthood is called adolescence with accelerated physical growth .

Out of all the stages of life, the most fascinating is the adolescent age



During this phase, a child is going through many changes in his/her body – changes occur in hormones, skin, height and weight. The child observes these changes and makes amendments in his/her eating habits without appropriate guidance.

Adolescence is a significant period for physical growth and sexual maturation. Nutrition being an important determinant of physical growth of adolescents is an important area that needs attention.

Inadequate nutritional intake during adolescence can have serious consequences throughout the reproductive years and beyond. Poor nutrition during adolescence can impair the work capacity and productivity of adolescent boys and girls in their later years. Further, an undernourished girl is at the risk of developing complications during pregnancy and the chances of her giving birth to a low birth weight baby increases, thus perpetuating a vicious cycle of malnutrition and ill-health.

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